Beginning to the End

By Mary Krell-Oishi

(SHE and HE go through their relationship from when it starts to the final moment. Note: They do not speak directly to each other until specified in the script.)

HE: **(Pg 91+)** I asked her to go out with me about a month ago.

SHE: He's the cutest guy I've ever known.

HE: We hardly ever disagree.

SHE: We feel the same about almost everything.

HE: It's like we think the same thoughts.

SHE: Well, we do have one disagreement.

HE: There is one thing that kind of hangs us up.

SHE: I know he loves me. He says he does. He wouldn't lie about that.

HE: I respect her, I love her, everything. I don't know how else I can make her believe me. I would never hurt her.

SHE: I want to prove to him that I believe him and that I love him. It's just that. . .

HE: I don't know what the big deal is. I mean, I know we'll end up married some day. I feel it in my heart. There's no one else for me but her.

SHE: I feel like I'm disappointing him by holding back. But if I don't, that means I give up everything to him. Not that I don't want to. I do. But I don't know if I'm ready now. Not yet.

HE: I know that I'm ready. I think she is, too, but I think she's got some "social hang-up" about it. Like she's worried about what people will think. She should only be concerned about us, not anyone else. It's us that's important.

SHE: He is the most important thing to me. Maybe I'm just being silly.

HE: Not that I'd break up with her over this, but it's frustrating.

SHE: I just love him so much. I do. Maybe saying it isn't enough.

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INTRODUCTION

ACTOR: **According to the CDC, teen pregnancy rates are the lowest they have been in decades.*
ACTRESS: *However, some doctors, service providers and advocates are worried.*
ACTOR: *They site several factors, including intensifying political pushback against sex education and the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on youth mental health.*
ACTRESS: *Decades of progress could begin to unravel. Teen pregnancy rates could again begin to rise.*
ACTOR: *And teens, ill-equipped to make such harrowing decisions about relationships and their futures, will be faced with monumental adult choices.*
TOGETHER: *Beginning to the End by Mary Krell-Oishi*

HE: She called me and said she wanted to see me.

SHE: I've thought a lot about it.

HE: She said it was important.

SHE: So, I made up my mind.

HE: She said it would be something special.

SHE: I want it to be special.

HE: I wonder. . . I hope. . .

SHE: Words just aren't enough.

HE: I love her. She must know that. We are as close as two people can be.

SHE: We share such a special experience. No one else will ever have that part of my soul. I feel like I could fly.

HE: This is what love is. I would do anything for her.

SHE: He walks into the room and my heart skips a beat. He fills the room with his light.

HE: Forever. Things will always be like this between us.

SHE: I feel different.

HE: Things will never change.

SHE: Things aren't right.

HE: She's been acting kinda funny lately. She's so moody.

SHE: I feel like crap.

HE: What's her problem? Everyday she's in a mood. It's getting old.

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SHE: Something's just not right. Not with me, not with us.

HE: I'm getting really tired of her attitude lately.

SHE: I've been so moody lately. I don't know what's wrong.

HE: Things are still good, you know, between us. But other stuff, just talking and all, that's not so good. It's like we have nothing to say to each other without it turning into a disagreement. Not really a fight, but bickering. And it's not my fault. It's her.

SHE: He picks on me. No matter what I do or say, he has to comment on it. And I'm crying all the time lately. And when I cry I get "nerve-hungry" so I have to eat. I've probably gained five pounds.

HE: I don't know what her problem is, but it better stop. At first the tears were kind of cute, but now it's just old.

SHE: I'm tired of crying.

HE: She better snap out of it.

SHE: I'm so tired all the time.

HE: She's getting to be such a drag to be around. She's always tired.

SHE: Maybe I need vitamins or something.

HE: She said she needs to be alone for a couple days.

SHE: I need to think things through.

HE: Alone. Alone alone, not together alone. I can feel that things are not right.

SHE: I can't shut him out now. I need him.

HE: She's shutting me out. Maybe she's found someone else.

SHE: I need him to be there.

HE: If she's tired of me, fine. Hey, whatever.

SHE: I'm going to tell him today.

HE: She said she wanted to see me today. I wonder if this is it. The end. After the way she's been for the last few weeks, that would be fine with me. I don't need the moods.

SHE: I need for him to be strong. To be understanding and loving. I need to talk to him soon.

HE: She called me last night to ask me to meet her before school starts. I guess that means

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we're cutting morning classes. Hmmm. This doesn't sound good.

SHE: I asked him to meet me before school, that way we could skip classes and be alone.

HE: I don't like cutting classes. Not when we're this close to graduation and I have a good chance at a scholarship. This better be important.

SHE: Some things are just more important than school right now, you know?

HE: She says she "needs to talk." That can only mean trouble.

SHE: I need to talk to him. It's serious, you know. . .

HE: I know this is going to be something serious. Some really serious stuff.

SHE: I'm worried how he'll take this.

HE: I mean, what's the worst it could be?

SHE: This is the worst thing that could happen. I thought we were so careful.

HE: She's pregnant. Pregnant.

SHE: I'm pregnant.

HE: What a weird word. Say it out loud. Pregnant. It's not a word that is easy to say.

SHE: Pregnant. Try saying it fast five times without gagging. I guess it's not so hard when you're not the one who's in the condition.

HE: What does she want from me?

SHE: What are we going to do?

HE: She said she was on the pill.

SHE: I started the pill. But I guess I was too late or missed a day or something. I never needed it before because I never did this with anyone before.

HE: She told me there wouldn't be a problem.

SHE: I didn't think that this could happen to someone like me.

HE: I can't believe this is happening.

SHE: I'm so scared.

HE: My life is shot to hell.

SHE: What am I going to do?

HE: She's so irresponsible.

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SHE: He's so angry.

HE: I feel like I've been betrayed.

SHE: The look in his eyes. I will never forget that look.

HE: OK, think. What am I going to do?

SHE: It's not like I planned for this to happen.

HE: This was definitely not in my plans.

SHE: He just looked at me and walked away.

HE: I didn't know what to say to her. I still don't.

SHE: He walked away.

HE: I just walked away. I mean, I'm going to call her and talk about what she is. . .we are going to do.

SHE: He called me last night. He sounded so distant.

HE: I could hardly talk to her. I'm so mad.

SHE: I didn't do this alone, you know.

HE: This is so wrong. I have plans. I'm going to college, I got a great scholarship.

SHE: He acts like he's the only one who's affected by this.

HE: I can't just give it all up.

SHE: This is my life.

HE: She can't expect me to give everything up.

SHE: I'll have to give everything up.

HE: I won't be an adult when I haven't had time to be a kid.

SHE: I'm so scared.

HE: Why did this happen?

SHE: What if he never calls me again?

HE: I have to call her and get this settled.

SHE: He said he loved me. Was that a lie?

HE: I do love her. But, I mean, maybe she's not the right one.

SHE: He told me that he'd always be there for me. Always. I thought he was the right one.

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HE: I guess I was wrong.

SHE: What am I going to do?

HE: What does she want me to do?

SHE: Will I have to quit school?

HE: I'll have to give up college and get a job.

SHE: College is out.

HE: I'll probably have to marry her.

SHE: How can I have a career and a baby?

HE: I could join the army, I guess. That way I'd get paid and could save for college.

SHE: I don't want to do this.

HE: My parents are going to flip out. . .

SHE: I can't have a baby.

HE: . . . but, maybe if I tell them about it in a way that shows them I'm handling it. Show them that I can take care of things.

SHE: I don't want a baby, not now.

HE: It could work out.

SHE: He doesn't want it either. Look how he acted.

HE: I'll call her tonight.

SHE: I am totally alone in this.

HE: Maybe she'll go away and have the baby and then we can figure something out.

SHE: I am on my own. He's made that crystal clear.

HE: She wasn't home. Her mom said she was over at Angela's house spending the night. But I went over there and no one answered the door.

SHE: I need to think this through.

HE: I'll see her at school later. Tell her that, even though I am not happy about all this, I will take care of my responsibility.

SHE: It's my responsibility. It's my body.

HE: She wasn't at school and when I called her at home, no one answered. What is going on?

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SHE: I feel like I'm dying inside.

HE: Where is she?

SHE: I made an appointment for the clinic for this afternoon. Angela said she'd go with me. I suppose I should tell him, but why?

HE: What is she doing?

SHE: When I first told him what was going on and he walked away, he walked out on me, on the situation, on everything I ever put my trust in.

HE: Angela told me that she was going to the clinic with her.

SHE: I can never trust him again.

HE: She can't do this.

SHE: *(She faces him)* It's my life.

HE: *(He faces her)* It's my baby, too.

SHE: You should have thought of that before you walked away.

HE: What did you expect me to do? I was shocked. It wasn't what I expected.

SHE: Funny, I said the same thing to myself as I watched you leave.

HE: You can't do this.

SHE: Try and stop me.

HE: But I love you.

SHE: Well, you have a helluva way of showing it.

HE: If you're doing this to punish me, it's the wrong way. I don't want you to do this.

SHE: Oh, really? So, you're ready to give up college, get married, pay bills, have a mortgage, and create a world for a child to live in? You're ready for all that, huh?

HE: No, I'm not ready. But there's really not much choice now, is there?

SHE: *(Quietly)* Yes, there is a choice. And it's my choice.

HE: Don't do this.

SHE: I have to.

HE: I told you, things will work out.

SHE: How? You join the army, travel around, save money, you go to college, you have your life.

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While I stay home and have the baby and find out in ten years that you don't love me enough to stay with me or the child after all? I'll be under thirty, with a ten-year-old and no future. Is that your plan for me?

HE: How can you say that? I love you. You know I do.

SHE: I thought you did. But you loved a little girl who thought the sun rose and set on you. Well, in the last few weeks I've had to grow up and make some hard choices.

HE: What about my choices?

SHE: You have none.

HE: I can't believe you would do this.

SHE: I can't either. But I am. And I will have to live with it.

HE: We're through, then, if you do this.

SHE: *(A long look)* We were through anyway.

HE: At least let me go in with you. We can talk to someone, a counselor. There are other options.

SHE: I've talked to the counselor. I am being set up with a good family.

HE: What?

SHE: I'm meeting with the family today that will adopt the baby.

HE: Adopt? You mean you're not having an abortion?

SHE: An abortion? No! How could you think I would do that?

HE: But. . . I just assumed.

SHE: How could you think that? Don't you know me at all?

HE: I guess I just thought that. . .

SHE: Thought what? After all this time we've been together, you actually believed that I could have an abortion?

HE: I'm sorry, I. . .

SHE: Go away, please.

HE: No. I need to be a part of this.

SHE: Why?

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HE: I don't know. I just do.

SHE: This is my decision, you know. You have no choices in this.

HE: I know.

SHE: Then why do you want to be there?

HE: I just want to be.

SHE: OK. *(He starts to put his hand on her back to guide her in. She quietly responds to his touch without anger, just very matter of fact)* Don't touch me.

HE: Sorry.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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**Source information for introductory material*
https://kffhealthnews.org/news/article/teen-pregnancy-birth-rate-trend-dobbs/

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